

13 February 2026

Dear Admissions Committee of IE University,

I am delighted to write this letter of recommendation for Otto Martin Sospedra. As a required part of his Swiss Federal Vocational Baccalaureate, he is completing a one-year internship at the Europe/Africa Office of Rotary International from 11 August 2025 until 10 August 2026. I have the privilege of being his direct manager during this year, carrying overall responsibility for his practical education.

Rotary International is one of the world's principal service organisations, headquartered in Evanston, Illinois, USA. The Europe/Africa Office in Zurich provides efficient, high-quality services to Rotarians in Europe, Africa, and the Middle East, supporting them in achieving their objectives. We employ 45 staff members from 22 different countries, and English is the main language spoken. Therefore, Otto is using English as his primary work language.

During his internship, Otto is rotating between our four departments: Administration/Global People & Talent, Philanthropy & Grants, Membership Growth & Experience, and Finance, and has so far supported fundraising, grant-related evaluations and membership development initiatives across Europe, Africa, and the Middle East. As of 1 April, he will further broaden his experience within our finance team.

I would like to highlight some of Otto's notable achievements, which have been highly relevant to his colleagues and our office in general. During his time in the Philanthropy & Grants department, he conducted an in-depth analysis of the Paul Harris Society members in Italy, generating insights through a structured evaluation of donor data and engagement patterns that were of strategic relevance to the regional leadership. The clarity and quality of his work resulted in an invitation to author an article for a future edition of the regional Rotary publication, reflecting the trust placed in him and the value of his analytical contribution.

Despite having a more practical educational background, Otto has strong analytical skills, intellectual curiosity, and the ability to interpret financial and organisational data and communicate his findings in a structured and accessible manner. He applied these skills when independently preparing presentations for our fundraisers based in Switzerland, Germany, Great Britain, Kenya and Nigeria.

Alongside his departmental responsibilities, Otto planned his own fundraising initiative in support of Rotary's global project, End Polio Now, managing the conceptualisation, communication, and operational preparation himself. Taking full responsibility for such a project shows a high degree of independence and willingness to take ownership.

Additionally, he supported me and our People & Talent team during various recruitment processes. He helped review applications, evaluate CVs and motivation letters, and provided structured feedback on candidates. Throughout these processes, he proved his ability to exercise discretion and sound judgement, always acting with professionalism.

Overall, Otto combines strong analytical capability with reliability, personal discipline, and a genuine commitment to excellence. I am confident that he has the intellectual ability, work ethic and leadership potential needed to excel in a demanding bachelor's degree programme. I therefore strongly recommend him for admission to IE University. I am confident that he will contribute positively to your institution's intellectual and international environment.


Ulla Korsgaard Larsen
Manager of Global People & Talent
Europe/Africa Office, R.I.